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OPR: WVOT Cybersecurity

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

Publications are available online at
https://sites.google.com/wv.gov/othub/policy-governance/ot-policies

Questions and change recommendations related to this publication shall be directed to this publication's Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR). This policy shall be reviewed annually to ensure continued alignment with current legal, operational, and strategic requirements. Revisions will be undertaken as necessary.

SUMMARY OF VERSIONS AND CHANGES

Date	Revision Description
03/23/2026	Reformatted and added Change Summary, Definitions, and Relevant Materials and Documents

1. PURPOSE

1.1. This policy outlines objectives and responsibilities to ensure the security of the West Virginia Office of Technology (WVOT) Data Center(s) by establishing authorization levels, controls, and vetting processes to ensure all personnel and vendors are properly authenticated and escorted.

2. SCOPE

2.1. This policy applies to all departments (including agencies, boards, authorities, and commissions) within the Executive Branch of WV State Government, excluding constitutional officers, the WV Board of Education, the WV Department of Education, and the county boards of education that have access to or use State-provided resources. This policy also applies to all State departments, vendors, contractors, and service providers requiring access to WVOT-run data centers.

2.2. Where there are policies in place which provide less restrictions or security than this policy, those policies will be superseded by this policy. In instances where existing state and federal laws, regulations, and policies are more restrictive than this policy, the more restrictive provisions will prevail.

3. POLICY

3.1. Physical Access

3.1.1. Access cards are issued only to individuals whose job functions require physical entry. All requests require a Data Center Access Request Form approved by an agency authority and the OT Data Center Manager. Types of access:

3.1.1.1. Unescorted: State employees whose work functions necessitate regular admittance.

3.1.1.2. Controlled Escorted: Individuals requiring occasional access must be escorted at all times by an authorized state employee.

3.1.1.3. Incident Qualified: Emergency personnel (police, fire) issued temporary access for the duration of an incident.

3.1.1.4. Three-Barrier Rule: Critical assets must be protected by at least three physical barriers (e.g., Building Access, DC Door, Locked Cabinet).

3.2. Vendor & Visitor Access Procedures

3.2.1. Vendor and Visitor access is subject to mandatory vetting, identity authentication, and continuous authorized escorting. All vendors and visitors must operate in accordance with West Virginia Office of Technology policies and remain compliant with all governing local, state, and federal laws.

3.2.2. Scheduling and Vetting Visits

3.2.2.1. Coordination: All visits must be coordinated through the Sponsor Agency or OT Service Owner.

3.2.2.2. Required Information: The sponsor must provide the vendor's staff name(s), company, estimated arrival time, and a detailed reason for visiting the Data Center in advance.

3.2.2.3. Referral Process: If a vendor contacts the Data Center Team directly, staff will refer them to their appropriate sponsor (e.g., referring a telecom vendor to the OT networking team).

3.2.2.4. **Emergent Access:** In urgent cases to prevent outages, long lead times are not required, but vendors and visitors must still be vetted and authenticated prior to entry.

3.2.3. Arrival and Check-In

3.2.3.1. Identification: Visitors must present a valid State ID, Driver's License, Military ID, or Federal Employer ID. Vendors must also present valid company-issued identification.

3.2.3.2. Validation: Credentials must be validated to ensure they match the scheduled party.

3.2.3.3. Visitor Log: All visitors and vendors must sign in to the Data Center visitor log upon entry and sign out upon exit.

3.2.3.3.1. All visitor logs are to be maintained for 5 years.

3.2.3.4. Escort Requirements

3.2.3.4.1. Authorized Escorts: Vendors must be escorted at all times by an authorized Sponsor Agency or OT personnel (the "Escorting Official").

3.2.3.4.2. Escort Responsibilities: The official is responsible for ensuring vendors only access equipment authorized by the sponsoring agency.

3.2.3.4.3. Prohibitions: Unescorted access for vendors or visitors is strictly prohibited.

3.2.4. Denial of Access

3.2.4.1. Access will be denied if:

3.2.4.1.1. The visit was not vetted through a sponsor or service owner.

3.2.4.1.2. The vendor does not match the scheduled identity or cannot present valid company ID.

3.2.4.1.3. The vendor arrives outside of the scheduled date.

3.3. Monitoring and Auditing

3.3.1. Authorization List: The Data Center Manager or designee maintains a master list of all authorized Data Center Cardholders.

3.3.2. Weekly Review: The Data Center Manager reviews all physical access attempts weekly. Unusual attempts are reported to Capitol Police.

3.3.2.1. Data Center corridor footage is monitored 24/7 by Capitol Police and the footage is retained for 28 days.

3.3.3. Monthly Reconciliation: Cardholder necessity is verified with sponsors monthly. Rack key inventories are reconciled monthly.

3.3.4. Status Changes: Sponsors must notify the Data Center Manager immediately (within 24 hours) upon an employee's termination or transfer to revoke access.

3.3.5. Lost Cards: Lost cards are deactivated immediately; replacement requires a new approved request form.

3.4. Operational Standards and Media Handling

3.4.1. Media Destruction: Decommissioned servers are de-racked with drives intact for destruction by OT surplus; drives must never be repurposed.

3.4.2. Faulty Media: Bad drives must be labeled (server, owner, date) and secured until destruction.

3.4.3. Handling Protocol: All media removed from the data center must be treated as if it contains FTI or SSA data.

3.4.4. Training: Employees with access to FTI/SSA data must complete annual compliant data handling training.

3.4.5. Cabling: New cables must be installed in overhead trays (ANSI/TIA-568-C standards), labeled at both ends, and old cables must be discarded.

3.4.5.1. Only authorized Data Center Staff may access cabling conduits.

3.4.5.2. Agency authorized personnel may only access their own cabling runs.

3.5. General Procedures

3.5.1. All servers, storage devices, and networking equipment in the Data Center must be rack mountable or capable of being stored in a server rack and properly secured within.

3.5.2. Server cabinets will be closed and locked when equipment is not actively being accessed.

3.5.3. No food or drinks are allowed in the Data Center.

3.5.4. No unauthorized hazardous materials are allowed within the Data Center.

3.5.5. Liquid cleaning supplies are not allowed within the Data Center without prior approval.

3.5.6. No cutting of materials (pipes, floor tile, etc.) will be performed within the Data Center unless special arrangements have been made with the Data Center Manager.

3.5.7. Floor tile is to be raised or removed only by Office of Technology Data Center Staff.

3.5.8. No server, storage, or network equipment may be stored on the floor, tables, window sills, on top of racks, or in any area that obstructs air circulation.

3.5.9. Paper products, boxes, or other disposable materials may not be stored within the Data Center other than the Visitor's Log, Signs for Procedures, or Safety Information.

3.5.10. Spare backup tapes, unused cabling, tools, or other miscellaneous equipment may not be stored within equipment racks or open areas of the Data Center without Data Center Manager approval.

3.5.11. No hanging or mounting of items on cage mesh walls or cabinets unless authorized by the Data Center Manager.

3.5.12. Equipment must be mounted within cabinets in a manner that heat is exhausted into hot aisles and never cold aisles.

3.5.13. No staging and unboxing of equipment within the Data Center.

3.5.14. Physical alterations or modifications of any space within the Data Center may not be made without the express written permission of the Data Center Manager.

3.5.15. Non-compliance with cabinet or room requirements may result in removal of equipment and time and materials fees assessed if Data Center staff must remediate the non-compliance.

3.5.16. All power distribution units must be UL or industry approved, and reviewed in advance with Data Center staff. Daisy-chaining power strips or other practices which violate electrical code is prohibited.

3.6. Inventory Management

3.6.1. All hardware installations and removals must be coordinated and scheduled with Data Center staff. Advanced notice of at least ten business days is required, although exceptions for emergent situations may be granted by the Data Center Manager.

3.6.1.1. Emergent situations are circumstances where equipment installation or removal are necessary to prevent outages or safeguard equipment.

3.6.2. All equipment in the Data Center will be identified and inventoried. The inventory will contain basic system and agency information.

3.6.3. The installation and removal of hardware will be monitored and the inventory updated to reflect the changes.

3.6.4. Agency hardware including racks, servers, networking equipment, and computing equipment are to be clearly labeled with agency contact information and device name.

3.6.5. Decommissioned equipment is to be promptly removed from the Data Center by the owning agency. Data Center staff members will be available to assist upon request.

3.6.6. Agency shipments destined for the Data Center must be coordinated and scheduled with Data Center staff. Advanced notice of at least 5 business days is required, although exceptions for emergent situations may be granted by the Data Center Manager. Shipments that have not been coordinated in advance will be refused. Data Center staff are not responsible for the inventory or security of any shipments received on behalf of agencies.

3.7. Key Control

3.7.1. Data Center keys shall be inventoried and reconciled monthly.

3.7.2. The combination to the Data Center Rack Keybox shall be changed quarterly and immediately upon the departure of any OT employee with Keybox access.

3.7.3. Only OT employees with job functions that necessitate access to data center racks shall be given access to the Data Center Keybox.

3.7.4. Rack keys shall be inventoried each time the Data Center Keybox is opened and any discrepancies shall be reported to the Data Center Manager immediately.

3.8. Environmental and Emergency Controls

3.8.1. DCSES Alerts: Systems must alert staff to out-of-range temperature/humidity, water detection, power loss, and fire alarm activation.

3.8.2. Emergency Power: Generators must start automatically and exercise under load weekly. UPS must provide at least 10 minutes of load time.

3.8.3. Fire/Smoke: Personnel must evacuate immediately upon detection and notify the fire department and Capitol Police.

3.8.3.1. Fire suppression systems are inspected annually.

3.8.4. Emergency Procedures: in the event of critical emergencies such as fire, water intrusion, HVAC failure, or power loss, Data Center Staff will follow the WVOT Data Center Emergency Response Procedure.

3.9. Enforcement

3.9.1. Strict adherence to this policy is mandatory. Non-compliance may result in revocation of access, disciplinary action up to dismissal, financial penalties, or criminal prosecution under applicable state and federal laws.

4. POLICY SPECIFIC DEFINITIONS

4.1. Chief Information Officer (CIO) - the person designated by the governor to lead the WV Office of Technology and oversee information technology practices and initiatives for the Executive Brand of WV State government, excluding the constitutional officers.

4.2. Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) - Person designated by the CIO to oversee information security practices and initiatives for the Executive Branch of WV State government, excluding the constitutional officers.

4.3. Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) - The primary section within WVOT that takes the lead on a specific policy or procedure. Usually the WVOT service provider/owner that the policy is related to or governs.

4.4. West Virginia Office of Technology (WVOT) - The division of the Department of Administration established by WV Code § 5A-6-4a, et. seq., which is led by the State's CIO and designated to acquire, operate, and maintain the State's technology infrastructure. The WVOT is responsible for evaluating equipment and services, and reviewing information technology contracts.

5. RELEVANT MATERIALS AND DOCUMENTS

5.1. WVOT Policies Issued by the Chief Information Officer (CIO), https://sites.google.com/wv.gov/othub/policy-governance/ot-policies